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21LEM202T — Unit 5, Session 3, SLO 1

Part B - In-Class Activity

Activity 1: Complete the statements from the lecture.

Statement	Complete / Answer
A profession is a mode of participation in the larger order for...	**the comprehensive human goal**
Professional success should not be judged only by...	**wealth generation**
Profession is also a means of one's...	**self-evolution through appropriate participation in the larger order**
Professional ethics means right utilization of...	**one's professional skills for participation in the larger order towards fulfilment of the comprehensive human goal**

Activity 2 - Salient Features of Professional Ethics

Write two or three key words for each feature.

Feature	Keywords / Meaning
Clarity about comprehensive human goal	**right understanding, purpose, co-existence**
Confidence in self and harmony/co-existence	**self-assurance, trust, mutual respect**
Competence of mutually fulfilling behaviour	**cooperation, empathy, win-win**
Competence of mutually enriching interaction with nature	**sustainability, cyclic, harmony with nature**
Holistic vision about technologies, production and management	**integration, human welfare, eco-friendly**
Understanding of societal responsibility	**accountability, service, justice**

Activity 3 - Root Cause or Symptom?

Classify each point as a symptom/current issue, a prevailing approach, or a root direction/solution.

Point	Category	Short Reason
Corruption and misuse of public funds	**symptom/current issue**	**it is a visible problem arising from lack of right understanding**
Prescribing codes of conduct and oaths	**prevailing approach**	**tries to enforce ethics externally without addressing root cause**
Building ethical competence through human education	**root direction/solution**	**develops right understanding and values from within**
Increasing punishment and audit mechanisms	**prevailing approach**	**focuses on deterrence, not on transforming human consciousness**
Value-based living based on right understanding	**root direction/solution**	**addresses the root by aligning thought and action with universal human goal**

Part C - Long-Answer Questions

1. Explain the meaning of profession in the context of the comprehensive human goal. (5 marks)

In the context of the comprehensive human goal, a profession is not merely a means of livelihood but a purposeful participation in the larger order of society and nature. It is an activity through which an individual contributes to the fulfilment of the four dimensions of human goal: right understanding, prosperity, fearlessness (trust), and co-existence with nature. A true profession aligns one's skills and work with the well-being of all, ensuring mutual fulfilment and harmony.

2. Define professional ethics in the light of right understanding and list its salient features. (5 marks)

Professional ethics in the light of right understanding is the set of values and conduct that arise from a correct perception of human reality, relationships, and the comprehensive human goal. Its salient features include: clarity about the comprehensive human goal, confidence in self and harmony/co-existence, competence of mutually fulfilling behaviour, competence of mutually enriching interaction with nature, holistic vision about technologies, production and management, and understanding of societal responsibility.

3. Why are many prevailing approaches to professional ethics considered inadequate? Explain with examples. (5 marks)

Many prevailing approaches to professional ethics are considered inadequate because they focus on external controls (codes, audits, punishments) rather than transforming the inner understanding of individuals. For example, prescribing codes of conduct and oaths often fails to prevent corruption because people may follow them mechanically without genuine commitment. Similarly, increasing punishment and audit mechanisms may deter some violations but does not address the root cause—lack of right understanding about human goals and relationships. These approaches treat symptoms rather than the root, and thus ethical behaviour remains fragile and conditional.

4. Choose one profession related to your branch. How can professional skill be used for mutual fulfilment and universal human order? (5 marks)

For a computer engineer, professional skill can be used for mutual fulfilment by developing software that serves genuine human needs—such as accessible healthcare apps, educational platforms for underprivileged communities, or tools that reduce resource waste. By designing systems that respect user privacy, promote trust, and are environmentally sustainable, the engineer contributes to universal human order. This approach ensures that technology enhances co-existence and prosperity for all, rather than merely generating profit or personal advancement.

Self-Reflection (Take-Home)

Do I see my future profession only as livelihood, or also as participation in the larger order?

In my field, what are two common unethical practices and what worldview supports them?

What one step can I take now to build ethical competence?

I see my future profession as both a livelihood and a participation in the larger order, because work gains deeper meaning when it contributes to societal well-being.

In my field (engineering), two common unethical practices are: (1) cutting corners in safety testing to reduce costs, supported by a worldview that prioritizes profit over human life; (2) plagiarism or intellectual property theft, supported by a worldview that sees success as a zero-sum game.

One step I can take now is to regularly reflect on the comprehensive human goal and discuss ethical dilemmas with peers, so that my decisions are guided by right understanding rather than external pressures.